

Headdress

Corythosaurus means "helmet lizard." Scientists named it so because of the crest on its head, which reminded them of helmets worn by the soldiers of ancient Greece.

Corythosaurus

ko-RITH-oh-SORE-us



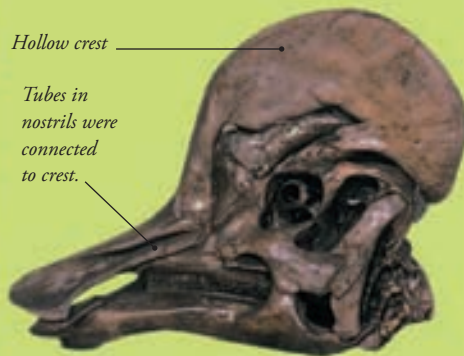
- **When** 76–74 million years ago (Late Cretaceous)
- **Fossil location** Canada, N. America
- **Habitat** Forests and swampy areas
- **Length** 30 ft (9 m)
- **Diet** Leaves, seeds, and pine needles

Corythosaurus was one of the larger hadrosaurids. Tall, bony spines on its back were covered with a frill of skin that formed a ridge running along its back. This frill was very prominent at the back of the head crest, where it was attached.



Hollow crest

Tubes in nostrils were connected to crest.



▲ SKULL

Corythosaurus's crest may have worked like a trombone, amplifying sound to make loud, booming calls that carried a long way. Perhaps these served as warning signals to alert other herd members of predators lurking nearby.



▲ FOSSILIZED SKIN

*Of the skeletons discovered, some had well-preserved impressions of skin. A few of these showed that *Corythosaurus's* belly had strange, wartlike lumps.*

